Annotation protocol 4.2 · tutorial 5.2 · 20 scored answers · English

T-CRED Annotator Guidelines

These instructions explain exactly how to review candidate answers, temporal validity, evidence, citations, graph paths, and refusals in the T-CRED study.

> **Judge only what this tool shows.** Do not search the web, use an AI tool, ask another person, or rely on unstated prior knowledge. The evidence is a frozen snapshot; outside information may describe another time and would make ratings incomparable.

Your work:
6 practice items, then 20 research answers.

Expected time:
about 10 minutes practice + about 60 minutes research.

When information is insufficient:
use *Cannot judge*; do not guess or search.

Saving:
local immediately; server after 1.5 seconds without another edit.

Identity:
use only the annotator ID supplied to you.

Finish:
open Final review and explicitly submit.

> Use a desktop or laptop computer. The study has dense evidence and graph displays; correct presentation on a mobile device is not guaranteed.

Practice labels and annotator ID 0 are excluded from scored results. Aggregate independent practice-check counts may be used as review signals, but never cause automatic exclusion.

1. Enter The Study

1. Open the study address supplied by the organizer.
2. Enter the assigned integer ID exactly. Do not use another person's ID.
3. Select **Continue**. The workspace does not offer an annotator-switch action.



Figure 1. The separate ID entry page. The organizer supplies the ID.

Read the study instruction before practice

This is not a memory test. A missing fact is not an invitation to look it up. It means the displayed material may be insufficient, in which case use the field's **Cannot judge** option or report a genuine data problem.

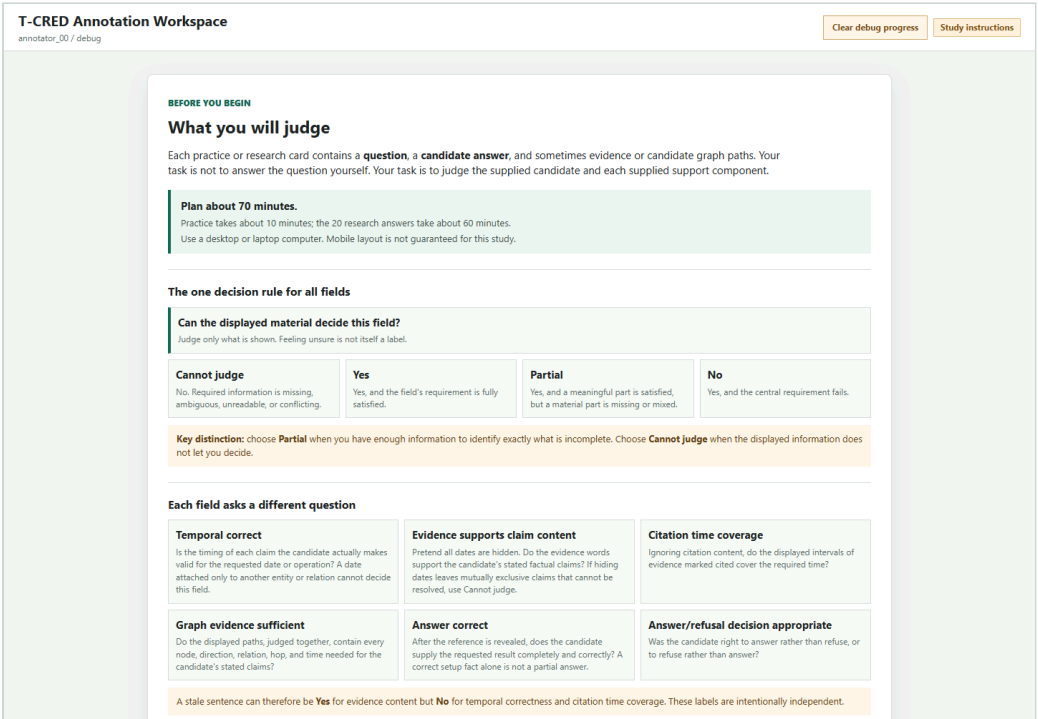


Figure 2. The frozen-snapshot rule and the two-stage task summary.

> Do not open the same annotator ID in several tabs, browsers, or devices. Revision protection prevents silent overwrites, but parallel copies can interrupt saving and require a reload.

The task in plain English

A QA system received a question and some retrieved material, then produced a **candidate answer**. You are reviewing the candidate and the material shown with it. You are not expected to know the real-world answer and you should not solve the question from memory.

You are judging

- whether the candidate uses the requested time correctly;
- whether the shown evidence supports its claim content;
- whether cited material is valid for the required time;
- whether the shown graph-path set collectively supports the candidate;
- after reference reveal, whether the candidate is correct and complete;
- whether the candidate made the right decision to answer or refuse, when that field appears.

You are not judging

- whether the answer sounds fluent or confident;
- whether another fact you remember would change it;
- whether an unseen website or graph path could support it;
- whether the system used the best possible retrieval method;
- whether all fields should receive the same label.

> Judge each visible field independently. A candidate may be factually correct but unsupported by its retrieved evidence. Old evidence may support the wording of a claim while being invalid for the requested date. Those are meaningful findings, not inconsistent ratings.

2. Know Where Everything Is

The desktop workspace follows one vertical reading order: review the full-width context, then move down to the full-width judgments. The form is never placed beside long evidence or graphs. Use the fixed section bar instead of repeatedly dragging the scrollbar.

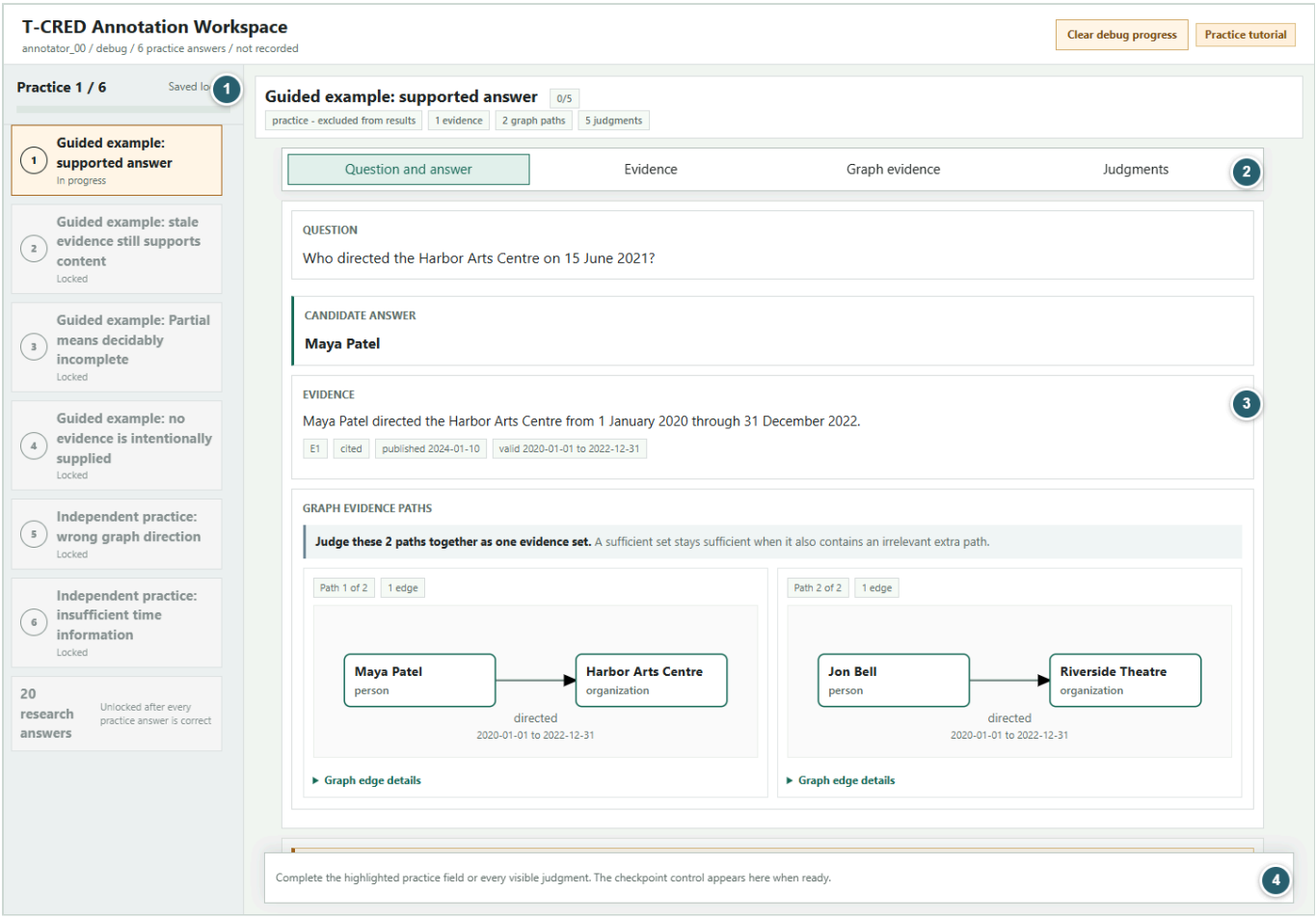


Figure 3. Main workspace. Numbered callouts are explained below.

1. **Assignment rail:** progress, save state, current item, and remaining practice or research answers.
2. **Section bar:** one-click jumps to Question and answer, Evidence, Graph evidence, or Judgments.
3. **Review context:** full-width question, candidate, evidence, dates, citations, and local graph paths.
4. **Persistent action area:** shows what is still required and presents Check or Lock/Reveal when available.

Where messages and controls appear

Save state	At the top of the assignment rail: Saved locally, Autosaving, Saving, Saved, or an explicit error.
Candidate-context note	Directly below the candidate when the card must clarify what support was available or whether a comparison set is complete.
Guided-practice hint	Inside the currently active judgment field in an amber **Practice guidance** box.
Wrong-practice explanation	Inside the red-highlighted field, immediately below its choices.
Decision definitions	Open **Decision rules** at the bottom of that field.
Partial/Cannot judge reason	A required menu appears directly below the field choices after selecting either label.
Stage checkpoint	In the persistent action area at the bottom of the workspace.
Logical contradiction	A red message below the judgment fields; it names only a strictly impossible combination.
Data/display problem	Below the judgment grid on research answers, separate from categorical labels.

On a narrow screen the assignment items become a horizontal strip and the section bar uses two rows. The context and judgments remain in the same vertical order.

3. Complete All Six Practice Items

The 20 research answers remain locked until every practice item is correct.

1. **Guided supported answer:** follow one field-specific explanation at a time and judge two paths together as one set.
2. **Guided stale evidence:** separate claim-content support from time validity.
3. **Guided incomplete answer:** learn when a decidable result is Partial.
4. **Guided justified refusal:** see which fields disappear when no evidence/path object exists and why Answer = No can coexist with Decision = Yes.
5. **Independent irrelevant-evidence and direction error:** separate the candidate's timing, evidence content, cited interval, and graph path instead of forcing them to agree.
6. **Independent unknown time:** distinguish insufficient dates from a known wrong date.

Guided practice

Only one field is active. Read its amber guidance, select the instructed label, and verify the stated reason against the displayed context. A wrong click does not advance the field.

The first practice item includes one sufficient path and one irrelevant extra path. **Graph evidence sufficient = Yes** because the paths are judged collectively: the irrelevant extra path does not cancel the complete one.

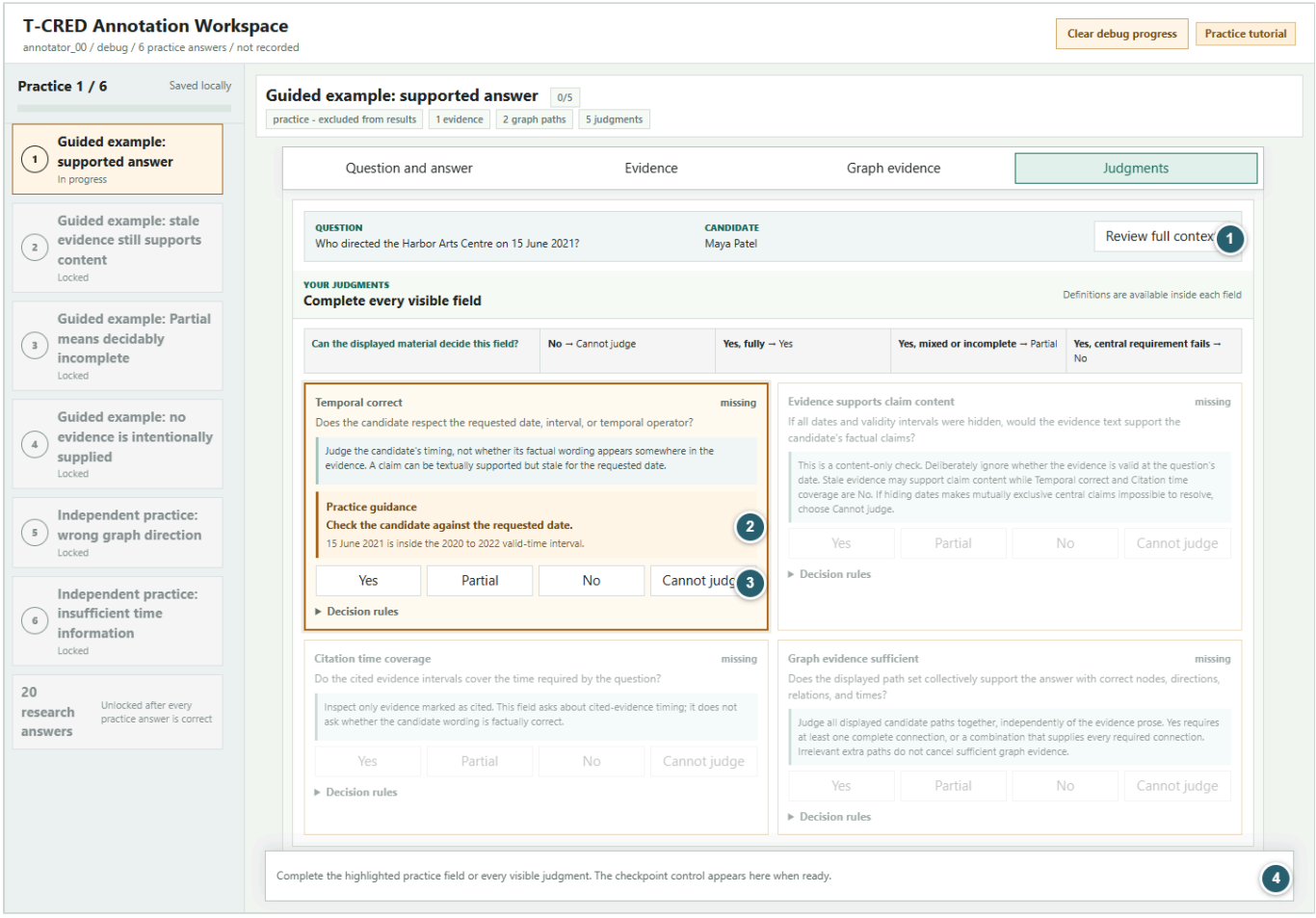


Figure 4. Callout 1 is the compact context reminder; 2 is field-local guidance; 3 is the active choice row; 4 is the persistent action area.

What the missing-evidence practice teaches

Some systems return no readable evidence or no graph path. That absence is not automatically a broken card. When a field has no object to judge, the tool omits that field and assigns Not applicable internally. Do not create a judgment for an omitted field.

This practice also separates the requested answer from the response decision. The revealed reference names Maya Patel, while the candidate says that there is not enough information. Select **Answer correct = No** because the candidate does not supply the requested name. Select **Answer/refusal decision appropriate = Yes** because the context shown to the candidate contains no basis for inventing that name.

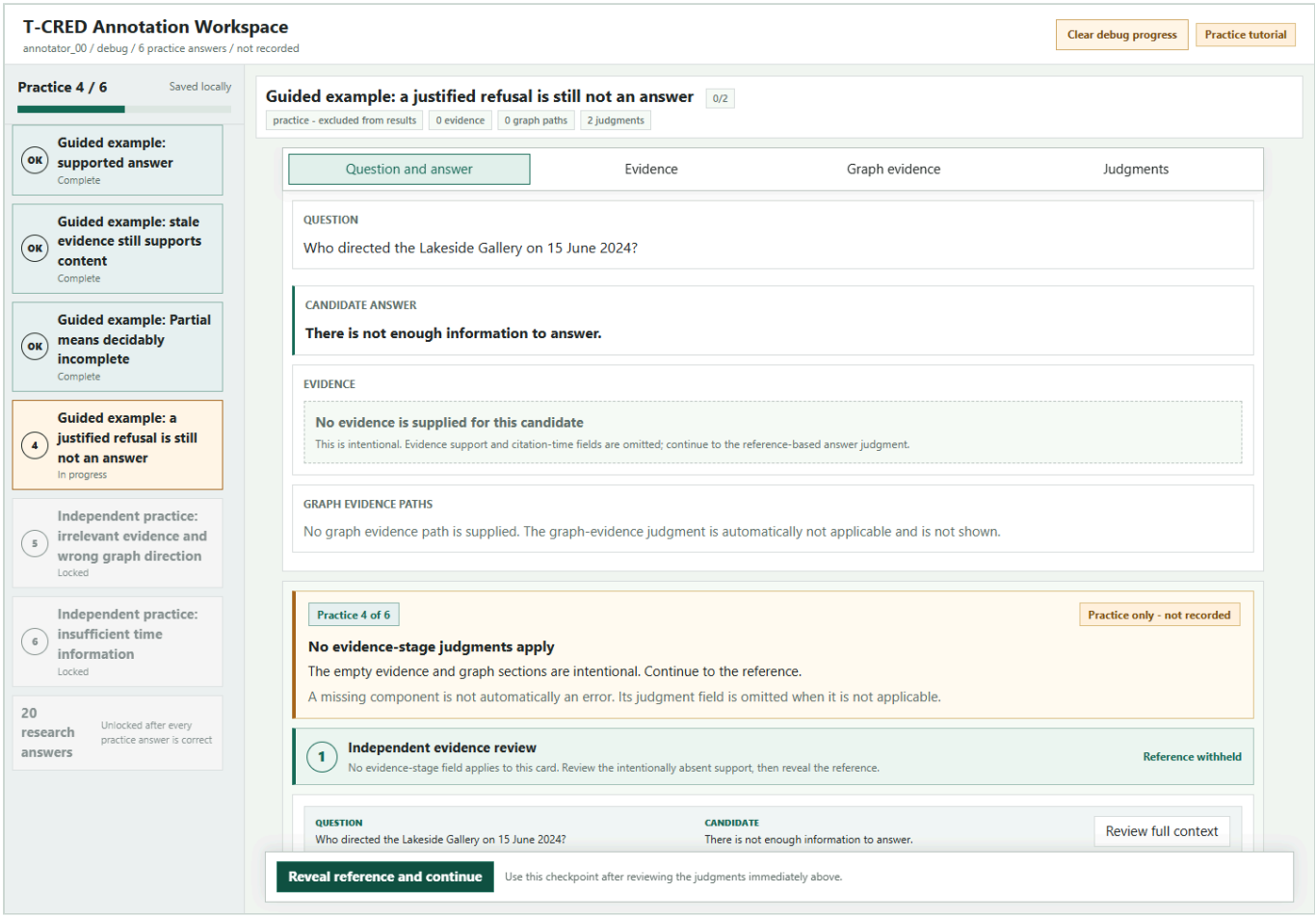


Figure 5. The empty-state explanation says that evidence/path judgments are intentionally omitted. Continue to reference review and judge the fields that are actually shown.

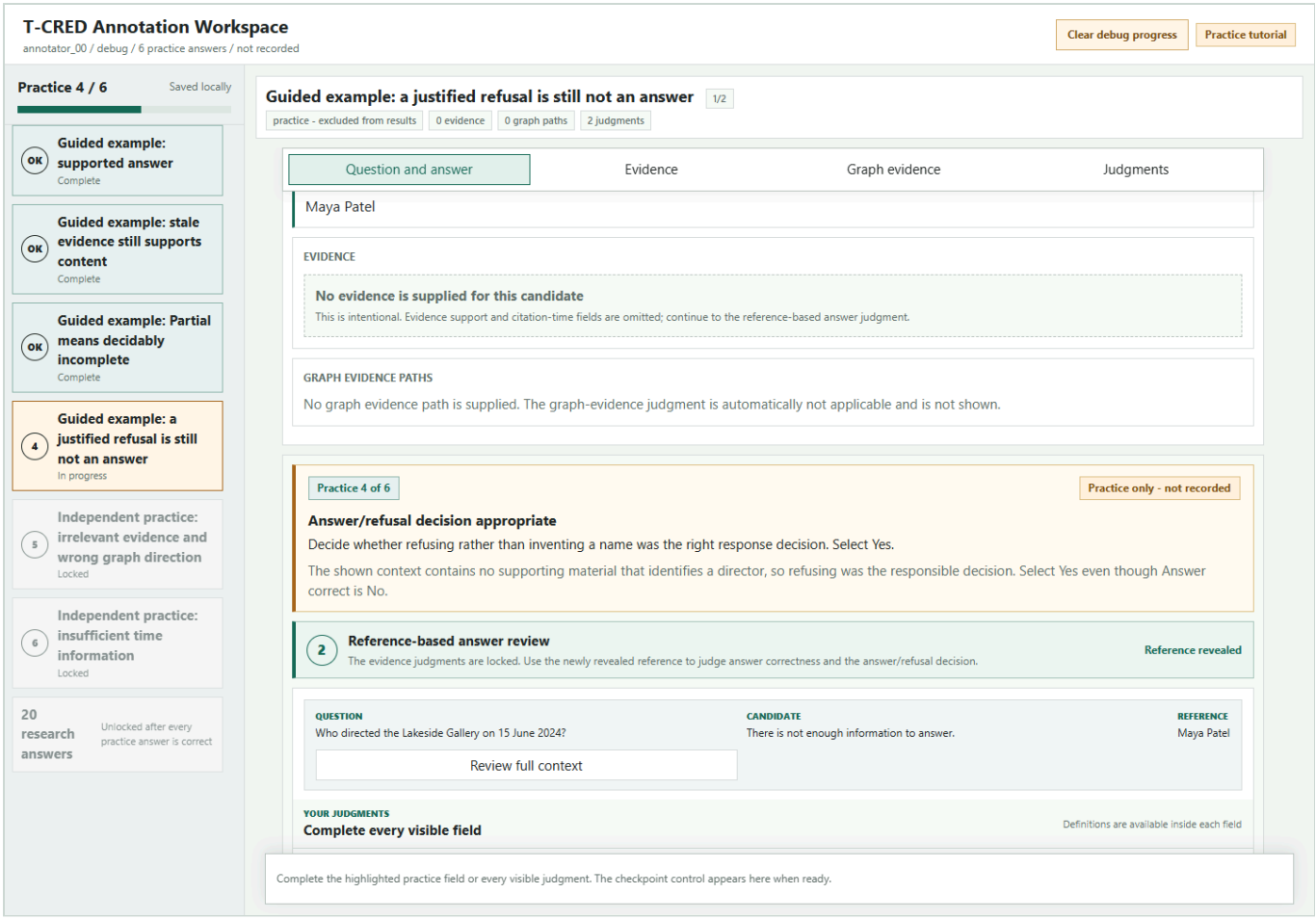


Figure 5b. The candidate supplies no requested name, so Answer correct is No. The shown context contains no basis for a name, so the answer/refusal decision is Yes. These fields deliberately measure different things.

> If a judgment field is visible but the material needed to decide it is absent, select **Cannot judge** and its reason. If the empty material appears to be an actual data/display failure rather than an intentional no-object case, also use the problem menu.

Independent practice uses two checkpoints

1. Complete every visible Stage 1 evidence, time, citation, and graph-evidence judgment.
2. Select **Check evidence judgments**.
3. If a field is wrong, it remains editable and receives an exact field-local explanation.
4. Change the judgment or required reason, then select **Check corrected judgments**.
5. Only after Stage 1 passes can you lock it and reveal the reference.
6. Complete Stage 2 and select **Check answer judgments**. Correct and recheck any highlighted field.

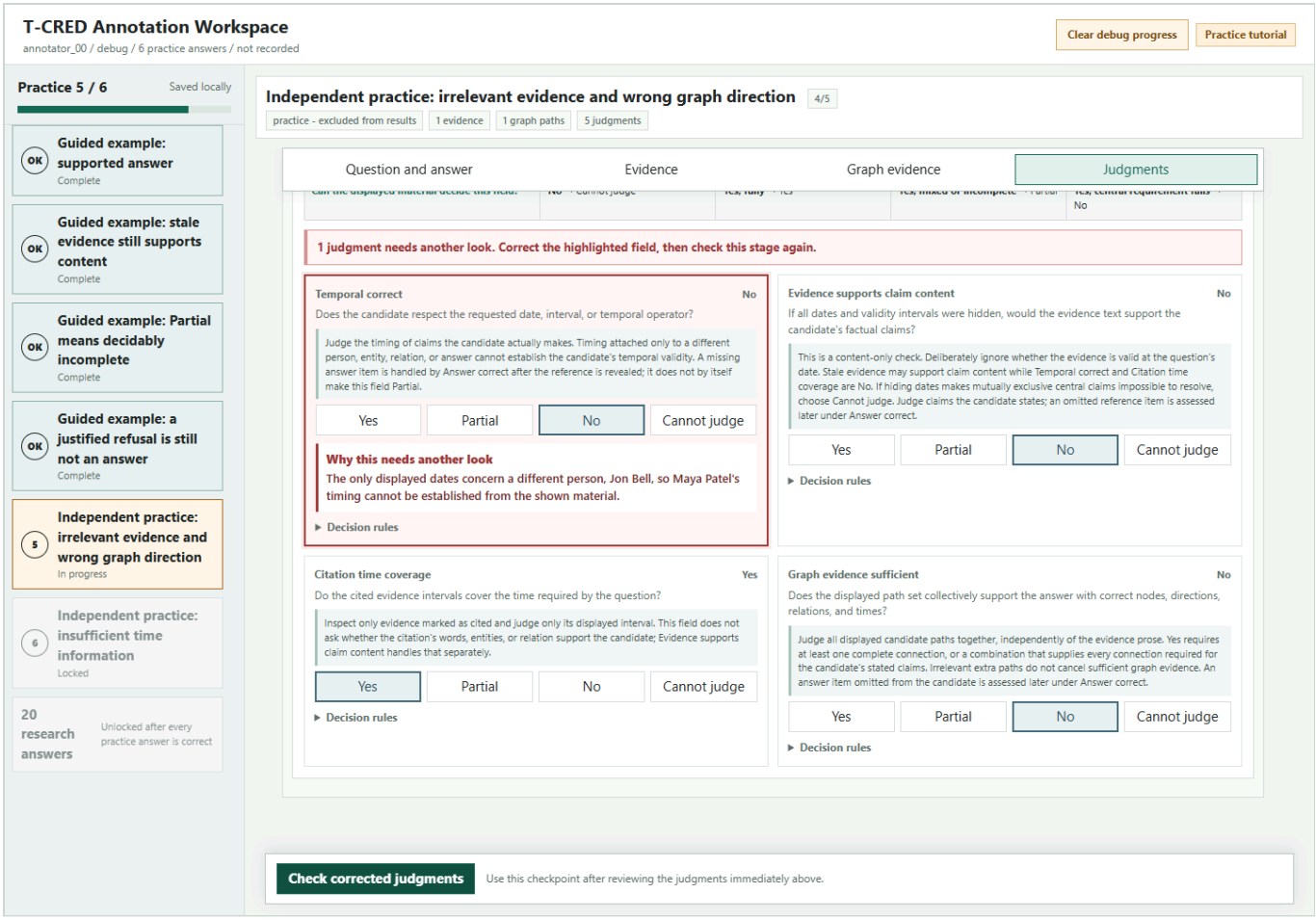


Figure 6. Marker 1 identifies the exact explanation; marker 2 identifies the still-editable choices; marker 3 identifies the recheck action. A wrong answer never leaves you stuck.

The deliberately surprising result in independent practice 5

The candidate names Maya, while the only dated citation concerns Jon and its graph edge also points the wrong way. The reference later confirms Maya. The intended independent judgments are **Temporal = Cannot judge** because no shown date applies to Maya; **Evidence = No**; **Citation time = Yes** because Jon's cited interval itself covers the requested date; **Graph = No**; and, after reference reveal, **Answer = Yes**.

> Practice choices remain in your browser and have no research unit ID. They do not count in 0/20 progress and never enter the final label dataset. Only aggregate attempt and failed- attempt counts from independent checkpoints are retained for quality review.

4. Follow The Two-Stage Rule

Stage 1: independent evidence review

Inspect the exact question, candidate answer, displayed evidence, valid times, citation markers, and candidate graph paths. The reference answer is absent. Complete every visible Stage 1 field and any reason menu required by Partial or Cannot judge.

Judge only claims the candidate actually states during Stage 1. Do not guess a missing reference item. An omitted list member is handled under Answer correct after reveal; it does not automatically make every Stage 1 field Partial. Likewise, a date attached only to another person, entity, relation, or answer cannot establish the candidate's timing.

Select **Lock evidence judgments and reveal reference** only when satisfied. This is irreversible. The server, not merely page styling, keeps the reference out of the Stage 1 response.

Stage 2: reference-based answer review

The reference now appears. Stage 1 decisions are shown as locked summaries. Judge answer correctness and, when visible, whether the candidate made the right answer/refusal decision. Do not reinterpret the earlier evidence judgments merely because the reference is surprising.

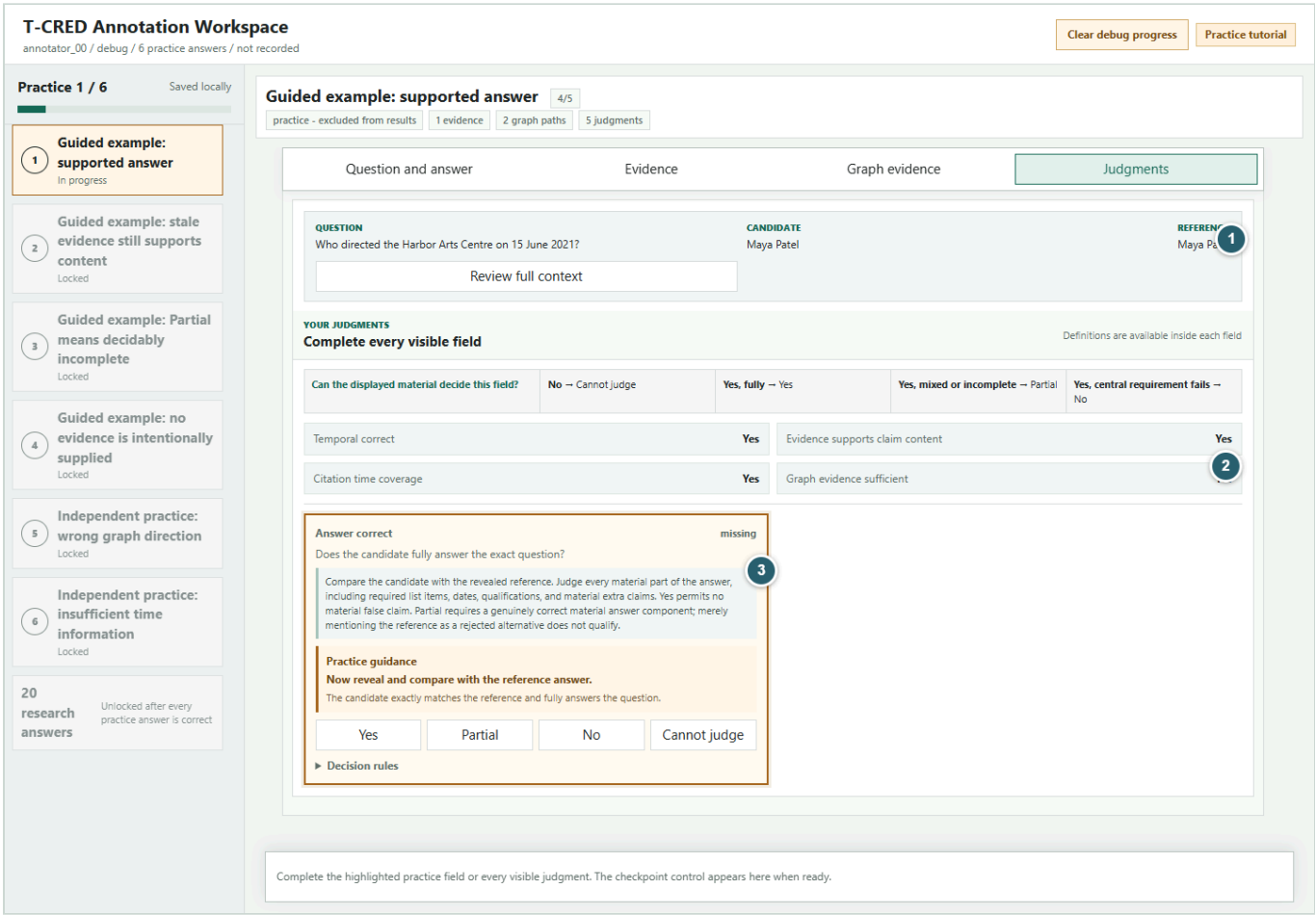


Figure 7. Callout 1 is the revealed reference, 2 is the immutable Stage 1 summary, and 3 is the editable Stage 2 answer field.

> The reference is a comparison anchor, not a string-matching rule. A paraphrase or equivalent complete set can be correct. If the reference genuinely conflicts with displayed evidence, use Cannot judge where appropriate and report *Reference conflicts with evidence*.

5. Use The Four Labels Consistently

Use this same decision sequence for every visible field:

1. Decidable?	No	Yes	Yes, but mixed
Can the displayed material establish a field-specific result?	Choose **Cannot judge**. Required information is unavailable, ambiguous, unreadable, or conflicting.	Choose **Yes** if complete, or **No** if the central requirement fails.	Choose **Partial** when a meaningful part succeeds and a material part is known to fail or be missing.

Visible choice	Use it when	Do not use it when
Yes	The complete field-specific condition is satisfied.	Only a meaningful subset is satisfied.
Partial	A meaningful core is supported or correct, but a material part is missing, mixed, vague, or incomplete.	The central claim is simply wrong or wholly unsupported.
No	The central field-specific condition fails.	The information needed to decide is absent or contradictory.
Cannot judge	The field applies, but displayed material is insufficient, ambiguous, unresolved, or conflicting.	You merely feel uncertain despite sufficient displayed information.

Selected Yes, Partial, No, and Cannot judge buttons all use the same neutral blue-gray highlight. Color never indicates whether your selection is expected or wrong. Red is reserved for an actual tutorial mismatch or a strict logical contradiction.

The decisive difference: Partial versus Cannot judge

Partial: enough information, incomplete result
Question asks for two co-directors. Reference lists Arun and Mei. Candidate gives only Arun.

Answer correct = Partial. You know exactly what is correct and what is missing.

Cannot judge: not enough information
A citation-time field is visible, but the cited item's validity interval is unknown.

Citation time coverage = Cannot judge. The needed date cannot be established.

Partial evidence support
Candidate makes two material claims. Displayed evidence supports one and contradicts the other.

Evidence supports claim content = Partial. The result is known and mixed.

Not Cannot judge merely because it is difficult
The graph is readable and shows the edge in the opposite direction from the candidate.

Graph evidence sufficient = No. The material decides the field.

Partial and Cannot judge require a reason

A field-specific menu appears immediately below the choices. Select the reason that best identifies the material limitation. The field remains incomplete until the reason is selected. An optional comment does not replace the structured reason.

Not applicable is automatic

You never choose `not_applicable`. The tool assigns it when a field has no object, for example when no explicit candidate graph path exists. **Cannot judge** is different: an object exists, but the displayed material does not permit a reliable decision.

6. Apply The Stage 1 Field Rules

> Judge fields independently. A candidate can happen to be correct while its retrieved evidence is poor. A cited interval can be in range even when its content is irrelevant. A path can be insufficient even when cited text supports the answer. Missing answer items are assessed after reference reveal and do not automatically lower Stage 1 fields.

What “if dates were hidden” means

The evidence-content field isolates semantic support from temporal validity. For that field only, mentally cover every publication date and validity interval. Ask whether the remaining words support the candidate's material claims. Then use the separate temporal and citation-time fields to judge whether that support is usable for the requested date.

Example: stale evidence can still support claim content
Question: Who was director on 1 January 2023? Candidate: Lina. Evidence says “Lina is director” but is valid only through 2020; another record shows Omar from 2021 onward.

Evidence supports claim content = Yes, because the words support “Lina is director” when dates are hidden. **Temporal correct = No** and **Citation time coverage = No**, because Lina is stale for 2023. After reference reveal, **Answer correct = No**.

Example: conflicting revisions after dates are hidden
One displayed revision says Mina is director and another says Omar is director. For Evidence supports claim content, hide their dates. If the remaining words do not identify which mutually exclusive claim governs, choose **Cannot judge**. Do not use the hidden revision dates to break the tie. Temporal and answer fields use their own displayed time/reference rules.

Field	Yes	Partial	No	Cannot judge
Temporal correct	Every material candidate claim respects the requested date, interval, order, or operator.	Only part of the requested interval or set is valid, or time scope is materially incomplete.	A claim is stale, future-invalid, out of range, or in the wrong temporal order.	Required valid time is missing, ambiguous, conflicting, or belongs only to another entity/relation and therefore does not establish the candidate's timing.
Evidence supports claim content	If all dates and validity intervals are hidden, displayed evidence directly supports every central candidate claim.	Only some material claims are supported, or a material uncertain inference is required.	The central claim is unsupported, irrelevant to the evidence, or contradicted by it.	The evidence text or claim-evidence link is too unclear or conflicting to assess.
Citation time coverage	Every displayed cited interval covers the requested or claimed time, regardless of whether the citation content supports the candidate.	Citation validity or interval coverage is mixed or incomplete.	A displayed cited interval is stale, future-invalid, or outside the required interval.	A cited item exists but its valid time or identity cannot be established.
Graph evidence sufficient	One path or a combination contains every material node, edge, direction, relation, and time needed for the candidate's stated claims. Irrelevant extras do not cancel it.	The set supports a meaningful subset of stated claims but misses a required hop, branch, or secondary connection.	The readable set contains no sufficient connection, or only materially wrong nodes, relations, directions, or times.	Graph evidence is shown, but missing time, ambiguity, unclear direction/relation, or rendering prevents a set-level judgment.

Temporal reading checklist

- Use the date or interval in the question, not today's date.
- Point dates and displayed start/end boundaries are inclusive.
- *At any time* requires any overlap; *throughout* requires coverage of the whole requested interval.
- *After* and *before* are strict; *by* includes its cutoff.
- When relationships tie for first, last, previous, or next, every tied item is required in the complete answer.
- Tied items may be listed in any textual order. However, words such as *then* or *followed by* assert a sequence; that assertion is temporally wrong when the items have the same timestamp.
- A fact with an open end remains valid after its start unless displayed material says otherwise.
- Do not replace an unknown date with an assumed one.
- During Stage 1, check the timing of claims actually stated. Use Stage 2 to penalize a missing list member.

How to read dated source wording

> **“In the Wikidata snapshot dated 1 January 2021 ...”**
>
> Judge what that frozen snapshot records. It does not ask what is true today. For example, “which employer does that snapshot identify?” is snapshot-relative even if the person later changed employer. In a question such as “whom did the person recorded as head of government succeed?”, first identify the office-holder recorded by that snapshot, then follow the displayed *replaces* relation in its shown direction.

> **“In the document revision for X dated 1 December 2024 ...”**
>
> Judge what that dated document revision states. Its revision date tells you when that version existed; it does not by itself prove that every statement was world-valid on that date. Use explicit validity information when a temporal-validity field appears.

A word such as *Current* can occasionally be part of an official role title. The source-frame note, not the everyday meaning of that word, determines the card's time scope. If the displayed material gives mutually exclusive values for the same central relation in the same snapshot and does not resolve them, use **Cannot judge** for the affected Stage 1 field. After reference reveal, compare answer content with the supplied reference; do not replace the reference with an outside answer.

7. Read Evidence, Citations, And Graph Paths

Evidence badges

- **cited:** the candidate explicitly cited this evidence item;
- **retrieved:** the QA system received the item but did not cite it;
- **published:** when the statement became visible in the source;
- **valid:** when the stated real-world relationship applies.

World-valid time and publication time are different. Use the field prompt to determine which one matters. Evidence claim-content support deliberately asks you to hide dates, while citation time coverage asks you to check them.

When evidence or a path is missing

- **No field shown:** the component has no object to judge. Do nothing; the tool records Not applicable.
- **Field shown but necessary material absent:** use Cannot judge and the matching missing-information reason.
- **Material visibly failed to load or required content appears corrupted:** also report a data/display problem.
- **No evidence does not automatically make the candidate answer wrong:** Stage 2 answer correctness is judged against the reference.
- **No path does not authorize inventing one:** judge only explicit candidate paths that the tool displays.

Graph direction and time

- Follow arrowheads. For a directed edge, source `->` target is not equivalent to target `->` source.
- Arrowheads at both ends mean the relation is explicitly bidirectional.
- **Reverse traversal** is not automatically wrong. Assess the displayed stored direction, traversal, relation, and evidence.
- Check every hop, including intermediate nodes and each edge's valid interval.
- If a long graph label ends in `...`, hover or keyboard-focus it, or open **Graph edge details**, to read the complete text.
- Judge every displayed path together as one set. One path may be sufficient, or several paths may combine to supply required branches.
- An irrelevant extra path does not turn an otherwise sufficient set into Partial or No.
- Judge only the candidate-local paths shown, not whether another unseen path might exist.

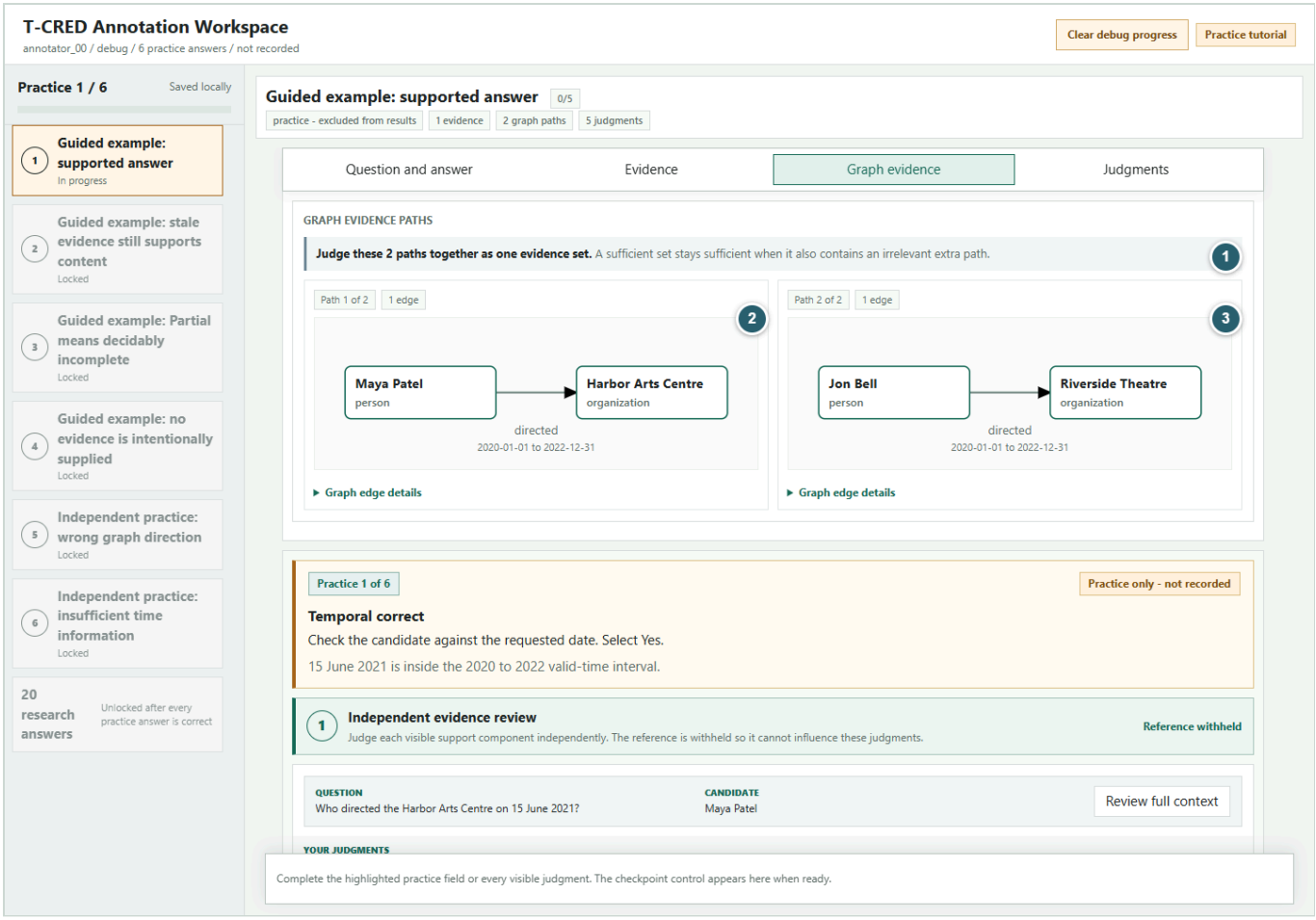


Figure 8. Callout 1 states the collective-set rule; 2 marks the sufficient candidate path; 3 marks an irrelevant extra path. Read arrowheads, relation labels, valid intervals, and node names. Open Graph edge details only when the redundant prose helps.

8. Apply The Stage 2 Field Rules

Field	Yes	Partial	No	Cannot judge
Answer correct	All material content correctly and completely answers the exact question.	A meaningful part of the requested result is correct, but a required part is missing, mixed, or has a minor non-fatal error.	The requested result is absent or centrally wrong, contradictory, or answers another question. A correct setup fact alone is not Partial.	The question, reference, and displayed material do not establish whether the candidate is correct.
Answer/refusal decision appropriate	The candidate correctly answers when support is sufficient, or correctly refuses when the information requires abstention.	The decision or caveat is partly justified, or a refusal is mixed with a materially overconfident answer.	The candidate refuses despite sufficient information, or answers when the information requires refusal.	The displayed material cannot establish whether answering or refusing was appropriate.

Correctness is semantic, not lexical

- Accept faithful paraphrases and equivalent date formats.
- For list questions, check completeness as well as membership.
- Extra harmless wording does not by itself make an answer wrong.
- **Yes permits no material false claim.** A materially false extra claim makes the answer Partial or No.
- Partial requires a genuinely correct part of the requested result. A correct subject, setup, or intermediate fact does not qualify when the requested value is withheld.
- A refusal that gives none of the requested result is Answer correct = No. It can still be Decision = Yes when the shown context genuinely does not support an answer.
- A partial requested list can earn Partial; a refusal followed only by background facts cannot.

Example: correct intermediate fact, justified refusal
Question: Where was the chairperson born? Candidate: “The chairperson is Peter, but the shown evidence does not state his birthplace.” Reference: Hanover. If the evidence really identifies Peter but contains no birthplace, use **Answer correct = No** because no birthplace is supplied, and **Decision = Yes** because refusing was justified by the candidate's shown context. The correct intermediate identity does not turn the missing requested value into Partial.

How to use a candidate-context note
If the note says support was available to the candidate, judge a refusal against that displayed support; do not assume the candidate saw nothing. If it says an ordering comparison set is complete, use all displayed eligible facts to assess first, last, latest, previous, next, or most-recent claims.

One strict contradiction

For a time-specific unit, `Answer correct = Yes` with `Temporal correct = No` is logically impossible. No other unusual label combination is warned.

9. Report Genuine Data Or Display Problems

Use the optional problem menu only for a problem with the unit or its display:

- question wording is materially ambiguous;
- reference conflicts with displayed evidence;
- required text, evidence, citation, or path content is missing;
- the graph cannot be read reliably;
- another concrete data/display problem, with a description.

Still provide every categorical judgment that can be made. A problem report does not automatically mean every field is No or Cannot judge. Use the optional comment for concise clarification, not for names, contact details, or other personal information.

> **Stop and contact the organizer** if the wrong annotator ID loaded, the assignment does not contain 20 scored answers, saving repeatedly fails, required content is broadly absent, or the interface is unreadable. Do not repair the task with outside search.

10. Navigate And Save Without Losing Work

Move within an answer

- Use the section bar for immediate jumps; the form remains below the review context.
- The judgment section repeats the question and candidate in a compact reminder.
- Use **Review full context** to return to the complete question and answer.
- Use Previous/Next or the assignment rail to change research answers.
- Use Open in the assignment rail to show only unfinished answers.

Research answers are intentionally ordered from lower to higher visible workload. Early cards usually have fewer judgments, evidence records, or graph edges. Later cards may take longer. This ordering helps you learn the workflow; it does not imply that an early candidate is more likely to be correct.

Autosave behavior

- Every edit is written to this browser immediately.
- Research edits are sent to the server 1.5 seconds after the latest edit.
- Several quick edits produce one server save after you pause.
- The save state changes through Autosaving, Saving, and Saved.
- A newer compatible local draft is restored after refresh.

You may pause and return using the same browser and annotator ID. Before closing the page, wait until the save state says **Saved**. Practice says **Saved locally** because practice labels are intentionally not research data.

> Plan about 10 minutes for practice and about 60 minutes for the 20 research answers. Consider a short break after roughly answer 10. Wait for **Saved** before closing, then resume in the same browser with the same annotator ID.

If saving reports an error

1. Do not open another tab and do not re-enter labels elsewhere.
2. Read the displayed message. If asked, reload the current page once.
3. Confirm that the compatible local draft was restored.
4. If saving still fails, stop and contact the organizer before continuing.

11. Review And Submit All 20 Answers

Completing the last field does not submit the assignment. Select **Review and submit**. Each row is either Ready or Review.

A Review row means one of the following objective blockers exists:

- a stage is unfinished;
- a Partial or Cannot judge reason is missing;
- required detail for Other data/display problem is missing;
- the strict temporal contradiction remains.

Select a Review row to return directly to that answer.

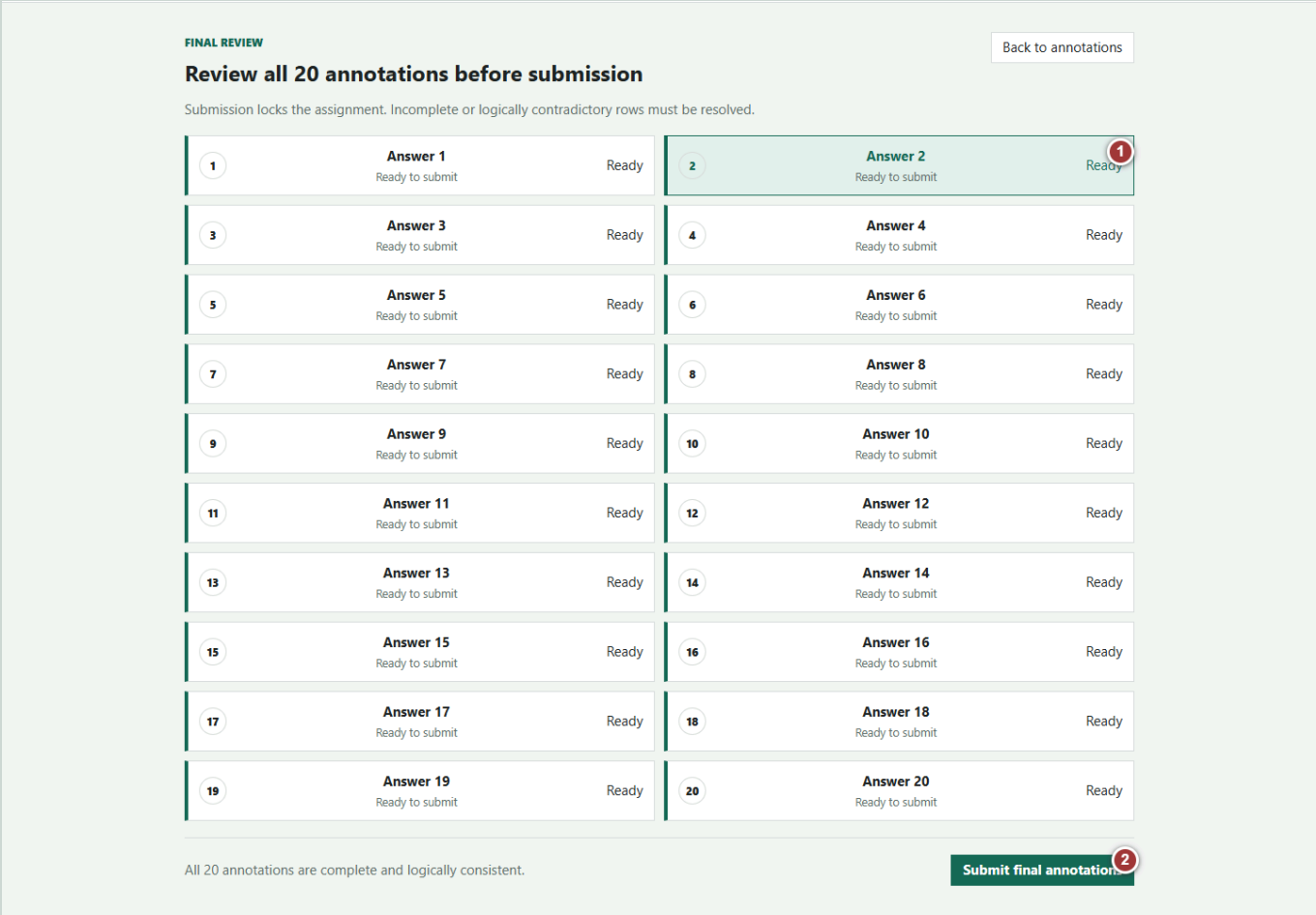


Figure 9. Callout 1 identifies per-answer readiness; callout 2 identifies the final submission action. Submission is enabled only when every row is ready.

Select **Submit final annotations**. The server validates all 20 answers again, freezes the result, and shows a completion page. After successful submission, the labels are read-only and the browser may be closed.

12. Final Checklist

- ☐ I used only information displayed in the annotation tool.
- ☐ I completed and understood all six practice items.
- ☐ I read the exact temporal operator and requested date or interval for every answer.
- ☐ I treated dated snapshots/revisions as frozen source states, not as present-day questions.
- ☐ I judged date-hidden claim-content support separately from temporal and citation validity.
- ☐ I treated conflicting date-hidden revisions as Cannot judge when content alone could not resolve them.
- ☐ I judged all displayed graph paths collectively and followed arrows, every required hop, and edge time.
- ☐ I treated all selected-label colors as neutral and did not interpret No as a wrong selection.
- ☐ I selected a structured reason for every Partial or Cannot judge label.
- ☐ I used Partial for a known incomplete/mixed result and Cannot judge for insufficient information.
- ☐ I did not invent a judgment for an evidence/path field that the tool omitted.
- ☐ I reported genuine data/display problems without using them as substitutes for labels.
- ☐ I reviewed all 20 scored answers.
- ☐ I waited for Saved and successfully selected Submit final annotations.

> The goal is not to agree with a presumed expected label. Apply the same explicit rules independently, distinguish wrong from unknowable, and report uncertainty honestly.